POINTS AND MOTIONS – WHAT DO YOU SAY?

TOPIC: LEARNING HOW TO USE MODEL UN POINTS AND MOTIONS

OBJECTIVES

- Identify important points and motions.
- Use points and motions correctly.

REQUIREMENTS

1. Time: 1-2 class periods
2. Materials Needed:
   - Handout H: Points and Motions Chart
   - Handout I: What Do You Say?

PROCEDURE

1. Lesson Introduction/Activation of Prior Knowledge

   Write a few of the points and motions terms on the board and ask students what they think these mean. Discuss their answers.

2. Activity

   Provide students with Handout K: Points and Motions Chart. See if their responses to the brainstorming activity above were similar to the definitions on the chart. Go over each of the points and motions on the chart with the students.

   Provide students with Handout I: What do you Say? Review the different scenarios with the students. Working in groups of 2-3 students ask them to write exactly what they think should be said to the chair. You may want to do a few of these exercises with them. This is also a good opportunity to invite a Model UN trainer to your class to help with Points and Motions.

   Once students have completed their charts, review their answers.

3. Closing/Wrap-Up

   Have student role play some of the scenarios with each other so they can practice the language and answer the questions.

POINTS AND MOTIONS – WHAT DO YOU SAY?

HANDOUT H: POINTS AND MOTIONS CHART

Motions	*Description*	*Vote to Pass*
Suspend the Meeting	Suspending the meeting means calling for a moderated or unmoderated caucus. When moving to suspend the meeting, delegates should specify the purpose for and length of the suspension. This motion requires an immediate vote.	Simple majority
Adjourn Meeting	Adjourning the meeting ends the committee session until the next session, which may be held the following year. The motion is most commonly made to end a committee session for the purpose of lunch or dinner. It requires an immediate vote.	Simple majority
Table Debate	This motion must not be confused with the motion to adjourn the meeting. Tabling debate ends debate on the topic. Delegates can table debate, move on to another topic and return to the first topic at a later time. Before going to a vote, two delegates must speak in favor of tabling debate and two speak against it.	Two-thirds majority
Close Debate	Closing debate allows the committee to move into voting procedure. Once a delegate feels that his or her country's position has been made clear, that there are enough draft resolutions on the floor and that all other delegates are ready, he or she can move for the closure of debate. Two delegates usually speak against the closure of debate. None speak for it.	Two-thirds majority
Appeal the Chair's Decision	This motion is made when a delegate feels that the chairperson has made an incorrect decision. The appeal must first be made in writing.	No vote
Point of Order	Points of order are used when delegates believe the chair has made an error in the running of the committee. Delegates rising to points of order may not speak on the substance of the matter under discussion. They should only specify the errors they believe were made in the formal committee procedure.	No vote
Point of Inquiry (or Point of Parliamentary Procedure)	When the floor is open (*i.e.*, no other delegate is speaking), a delegate may rise to a point of inquiry in order to ask the chairperson a question regarding the rules of procedure.	No vote
Point of Personal Privilege	Points of personal privilege are used to inform the chairperson of a physical discomfort a delegate is experiencing, such as the inability to hear another delegate's speech.	No vote
Point of Information	After a delegate has given a speech in formal debate, he or she may yield time to points of information, or questions from other delegates concerning the speech.	No vote

POINTS AND MOTIONS – WHAT DO YOU SAY?

HANDOUT I: WHAT DO YOU SAY?

Using the Handout H: Points and Motions Chart, determine which point or motion is being made under the Description. Then write exactly what you would say to make this point or motion.

Description	*What do you say?*
The delegate has a question regarding the rules of procedure.	
Delegate wishes to adjourn the meeting until next session. Usually used to adjourn for lunch or dinner.	
Delegate wishes to yield time to points of information or questions from other delegates about the speech.	
Delegate wishes to tell the chair about of a physical discomfort they are experiencing (the inability to hear another delegate's speech, that the room is too hot, etc.).	
Delegate wishes to suspend debate in order for a moderated or un-moderated caucus. The purpose and the length of the suspension need to be stated.	
Delegate wishes to end the debate on the topic. This topic can be returned to at a later time. Before going to a vote, two delegates must speak in favor of tabling the debate and two must speak against it.	
A delegate has just finished their speech. Another delegate would like to ask them a question about speech. (Please note, that a speaker must be open to questions.)	
The delegate feels that the chairperson has made an incorrect decision. The appeal must first be made in writing.	
Delegate wishes to close the debate and move to voting.	

POINTS AND MOTIONS – WHAT DO YOU SAY?

ANSWER KEY TO HANDOUT I: WHAT DO YOU SAY?

Description	*What do you say?*
The delegate has a question regarding the rules of procedure.	Honorable Chair, (Country Name) has a point of Inquiry.
Delegate wishes to adjourn the meeting until next session. Usually used to adjourn for lunch or dinner.	Honorable Chair, (Country Name) moves to suspend debate for the purpose of lunch
Delegate wishes to yield time to points of information or questions from other delegates about the speech.	Honorable Chair, (Country Name) yields to points of information OR Honorable Chair, (Country Name) is open to questions
Delegate wishes to tell the chair about of a physical discomfort the delegate is experience (the inability to hear another delegate's speech, that the room is too hot, etc.).	Honorable Chair, (Country Name) has a point of personal privilege, we cannot hear the speaker, the room is too hot, etc…
Delegate wishes to suspend debate in order for a moderated or un-moderated caucus. The purpose and the length of the suspension need to be stated.	Honorable Chair, (Country Name) moves to suspend the meeting for the purpose of a moderated/ caucus to discuss landmines for 25 minutes, with a 1 minute speaking time. OR Honorable Chair, (Country Name) moves to suspend the meeting for an un-moderated caucus for 20 minutes.
Delegate wishes to end the debate on the topic. This topic can be returned to at a later time. Before going to a vote, two delegates must speak in favor of tabling the debate and two must speak against it.	Honorable Chair, (Country Name) moves to table the topic of landmines to be discussed at a later time.
A delegate has just finished their speech. Another delegate would like to ask them a question about speech. (Please note, that a speaker must be open to questions.)	Honorable Chair, (Country Name) has a point of information for the delegate.
The delegate feels that the chairperson has made an incorrect decision. The appeal must first be made in writing.	Honorable Chair, (Country Name) moves for an Appeal of the Chair (after a note has been accepted).
Delegate wishes to close the debate and move to voting.	Honorable Chair, (Country Name) moves for Closure of Debate on this topic.